FOR PARENTS AND TEACHERS

Unit 9: Same sound, different letter

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1 In this unit

s: س ث ص · z: ز ذ ض ظ · t: ت ط · h: ہ ح — spelling must be memorised per word; these letters mark Arabic loans.



How long: About 2.5 hours for a child, 1 for an adult. Do 10 minutes a day, short and happy.

ص ض ط ظ ذ

2 What to say and show, letter by letter

	Say	How the pen moves	Often mixed up with
ص	**ṣwād** صاد 's' in sun	loop first, then the tail leftwards along the line	ẓwād, sīn
ض	**ẓwād** ضاد 'z' in zoo	loop first, then the tail leftwards; the dot last	ṣwād
ط	**ṭo'e** طوے soft 't'	small loop first, then the tall upright stroke	ẓo'e
ظ	**ẓo'e** ظوے 'z' in zoo	small loop first, then the tall upright stroke, then the dot last	ṭo'e
ذ	**ẕāl** ذال 'z' in zoo	top down and out to the left in one angled stroke; the dot last	dāl, ḍāl, ze

3 How to use the sheets

1. **Trace and write**: one page per letter. Start at the dot, follow the arrow; body first, dots last.
2. **Look-alikes**: circle the same letter, then sort by dots.
3. **Join the letters**: standing letters into a joined word.
4. **Read and match**: word to meaning.
5. **Reading practice**: words, sentences, story.
6. **Dictation**: the grown-up says it, the child writes it.
7. **Unit check**: 10 questions. The answer key is the last page of the unit-check PDF; in the unit pack the keys are on the last pages.

4 How to check

- **Letters:** cover the sound, point to the letter, the child says it. 3 of 4 right is a pass.
- **Writing:** look at the start dot and the direction, not at how pretty it is. Right to left, body first, dots last.
- **Unit check:** 8 of 10 means go on. Under 8: redo the look-alike and trace sheets, try again tomorrow.
- **Praise** effort: "you started on the right", "good dots". One sheet a day beats five at once.

5 A 10-minute sitting

2 min warm-up: point to last time's letters, the child says them. **5 min** the sheet of the day: say it, trace it, write it. **3 min** read it back together and end on something done well.